

O-Brain

O-Brain — Complete Beginner Guide



Even if computers / AI / software are brand new to you, just follow along. Hard words are explained in ().

0. What is O-Brain? (1-minute intro)

AI (Claude Code) is smart, but **the moment you close the chat it forgets everything** you just said — like a *brilliant friend with bad amnesia*.

O-Brain is the “auto-notepad” you keep next to that friend. - It automatically writes down important **decisions, promises, and rules** from your chats, - reminds the AI next time (the AI can even **trace relations & evolution** mid-chat), - and shows your memories as a **graph (map), an overview (at-a-glance summary), a list, and a timeline.** - **auto-tags which project** each memory belongs to (based on the files you actually worked on that session), - and shows new memories **on its own** (auto-refresh). - It runs **100% on your own PC** (nothing leaves over the internet).

Terms: **Claude Code** = an AI tool you use in a terminal. **Plugin** = an add-on you install into Claude Code. **Local** = inside your own PC.

1. Quick Start (3-minute summary)

In a hurry? Just do this. Details from section 3 onward.

1. **Install Node.js** (only if missing) → the **LTS** version at nodejs.org → after installing, **open a new window**.
 2. In the **Claude Code input box**, type these two lines one by one:

```
/plugin marketplace add D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_21d_SoDam_0-Brain\plugin  
/plugin install o-brain@o-brain-local
```
 3. **Restart Claude Code**. → Installation done.
 4. Chat as usual, then say a clear **decision sentence**. e.g., Let's set this project's port to 7740
 5. **End the chat** (type `/clear`). → Saved at this moment.
 6. To see the screen, type `/o-brain:open` in Claude Code → your memory map opens in the browser.
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2. Prerequisites · Required Programs · Downloads

What	Required?	Where / How
Windows PC	Required	This guide assumes Windows.
Node.js (LTS)	Required	nodejs.org → big green LTS button → download → keep clicking “Next”. (It’s the “engine” that runs programs.)
Claude Code	Required	The tool you already use.
Internet	Install only	Only for first install / first run (one-time download of a small AI model). After that, works offline.
Web browser	Required	Chrome, Edge, anything (to view the screen).

What	Required?	Where / How
API key / payment	Not needed	O-Brain costs nothing — 100% free and local.

Downloading O-Brain itself: It's already in

D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_21d_SoDam_O-Brain\. Nothing extra to download.

3. Install (just 2 steps, follow exactly)

The two lines below go into the **Claude Code input box** (prompt) — **inside Claude Code**, not Windows Explorer.

① **Register the marketplace** — tells it where the plugin folder is.

```
/plugin marketplace add D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_21d_SoDam_O-Brain\plugin
```

② **Install** — installs O-Brain from that list.

```
/plugin install o-brain@o-brain-local
```

③ **Restart Claude Code** → done.

- o-brain = plugin name, o-brain-local = marketplace (list) name.
- Doing `/plugin install <folder path>` in one step gives a “**Marketplace not found**” error. Always use the **2 steps**.
- If blocked with “not a git repo”, run `git init && git add -A && git commit -m init` in the plugin folder, then retry ①.

4. Check it installed

In the Claude Code input box: - `/o-brain:status` → shows memory count, recent memories, and status (in Korean). - `/o-brain:selftest` → one-shot brain check (save / secret-masking / search).    means OK.

5. How to Use & How It Works (the key part — very easy)

How it works, in one line: *When you end a chat, O-Brain scans it and auto-saves only the “decision / promise / rule” sentences.*

1. **Chat as usual.**
2. Say things you want remembered as **clear decision sentences**.
 - Good: Let's set this project's test port to 7740 / Never commit API keys
 - Not captured: small talk, plain commands like `cd folder`. (Only clear “decide / use / forbid”-type lines.)
3. **End the chat:** type `/clear` (or close the window). → **Saved at this moment.**
4. Verify: `/o-brain:status` → memory count grows and your sentence appears.
5. **(Optional) Higher quality:** type `/o-brain:remember` → I (the AI) pick only this chat's decisions and save them (the installed Claude Code/Codex does it — **no API key / cost**). To link memories, use `/o-brain:link` (I suggest related memories → you confirm the type).

Automatic security: passwords / API keys (sk-... etc.) are **masked before being stored** ([REDACTED]). This is not a “100% safe” guarantee — always stay careful.

6. Using the Dashboard

To open: type `/o-brain:open` in Claude Code (starts the server if it's off, then opens the browser). Address: `http://127.0.0.1:7740/` (bookmark it to reopen with one click).

Four views (top tabs — Graph is the start screen): - **Graph** — a map of dots and lines (toggle 2D / 3D). **This is the screen you land on.** - **Overview** — an at-a-glance summary: total count, last 7 days, **distribution by type/topic/project**, most-connected memories, most-viewed. Click **“connected-less memories”** to see only the orphans in the graph. - **List** — memories as cards: type badge, importance (★), date, view count. (As it grows, use **“Load more”** at the bottom.) - **Timeline** — chronological.

Quick search/navigation: press ⌘K (Mac) / Ctrl+K (Windows) anywhere to open a small palette that finds *commands* (*switch views, theme, export*) and *memories* at once and jumps right there.

In the graph you can: - **Hover** a dot → connected memories highlight. - **Click** a dot → details open on the right. - **Search** — top box (press / to jump there). Matching dots brighten in the graph. - “분류색” (**category color**) **button** — recolor dots by *type* ↔ *topic* (security, UI, deploy, ...). - “전체 보기” (**show all**) / **focus** — the ◎ (**target**) **button** in the detail panel shows *only that memory and its direct links*; “전체 보기” returns to the full map. - **Frequently-opened memories glow brighter** (view count). - **Zoom** — + / - / fit buttons at bottom-right. - **As memories grow**, the graph shows the *most important ones first* and tells you “**top M of N**” (so it stays fast).

Detail panel (right side, when a memory is clicked): - Content, type, category, importance, source, confidence, date, view count. - **Copy** / **Edit** (✎ **content** · **type** · **importance**) / **Delete** (irreversible, but a startup backup exists) / ◎ **Focus**. - *Even on edit, secrets like passwords/keys are auto-redacted again when saved.* - “**This memory’s relations**” — link to other memories as **supersedes** / **supports** / **influences** / **contradicts** (mis-click → “undo” to restore). It **suggests likely related memories** — click one to fill the target, then **just pick the type** (no need to hunt through the list).

Top tools: search · type/category chips · **importance, period & project filters** (by recent activity) · sort (newest/oldest/importance) · **refresh** (↻) · **light/dark theme** · **export** (JSON/Markdown).

Auto-refresh: new memories appear **on their own** (when you return to the tab or after a short wait). In a hurry? Click the top-right **refresh** (↻) **button** to update instantly.

Automatic project tagging: each memory is tagged with **the project whose files you actually edited that session** — no matter where you launched Claude Code, it uses the project you touched most. (Applies from the next /clear; old memories keep their previous tag.)

7. Commands at a Glance

What	Where	Command
Install ① register	Claude Code	<code>/plugin marketplace add</code> <code>D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_21d_SoDam_O-Brain\plugin</code>
Install ② install	Claude Code	<code>/plugin install o-brain@o-brain-local</code>
Status	Claude Code	<code>/o-brain:status</code>
Self-test	Claude Code	<code>/o-brain:selftest</code>
Save memory (manual, high-quality)	Claude Code	<code>/o-brain:remember</code>
Link memories (relations)	Claude Code	<code>/o-brain:link</code>
Backup	Claude Code	<code>/o-brain:backup</code>
Open dashboard (auto, recommended)	Claude Code	<code>/o-brain:open</code>
Screen (manual)	Terminal	<code>cd</code> <code>D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_21d_SoDam_O-Brain\app → npm start</code>
Screen URL	Browser	<code>http://127.0.0.1:7740/</code>
Backup (manual)	Terminal	<code>cd ...\app → npm run backup</code>

8. Workflow (an example day)

1. **Start working** — when you open Claude Code, some past memories are auto-referenced by the AI (read-back).
2. **While working** — when a key decision is made, state it clearly (it becomes a save target).
3. **Finish** — end the session with `/clear` → that chat's decisions get saved.

4. **Sometimes** — open the screen with `/o-brain:open` to browse memories, link relations, or delete what you don't need.
 5. **Periodically** — back up with `/o-brain:backup` (also auto-backs up when the server starts).
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9. File · Data · Document Locations (absolute paths)

What	Location
Project folder	D:\AI_Dev_Work\2026y\26y_06m_21d_SoDam_O-Brain\
Local app (code)	...\app\
Plugin	...\plugin\
Memory DB (precious)	...\app\data\obrain.db
Backup folder	...\app\data\backup\ (keeps latest 7)
Settings file	...\app\.env.local (sample: .env.local.example)
User README	...\README.md (Korean) · ...\README.en.md (English)
This guide	...\GUIDE.ko.md · ...\GUIDE.en.md (+ each .pdf)
Design docs (for devs)	...\PRD\ (hidden folder, 13 docs)
Implementation brief	...\AGENTS.md

Key settings (.env.local): *(defaults are fine for most — only when changing, copy .env.local.example to .env.local)* - `OBRAIN_PORT` — the screen's port (default 7740). Change it on conflict. - `OBRAIN_DATA_DIR` — folder to store memories (default `app\data`). - `OBRAIN_EXTRACT_MODE` — extraction mode (default `rule` = rule-based, free, local auto-capture). AI-quality capture needs **no API key** — the host LLM (Claude Code/Codex) does it via `/o-brain:remember`. Zero billing. - `OBRAIN_VEC_GATE` — search sensitivity (default 0.92; lower = stricter).

10. Backup & Restore (protect your memories)

- **Backup:** `/o-brain:backup` (or `npm run backup`). Also auto-runs once when the server starts.
 - Location: `... \app\data\backup\` (keeps the latest 7 automatically)
 - **Restore:** if something breaks, copy the most recent `obrain-....db` from `backup\` over `app\data\obrain.db`. (Copy the current file elsewhere first.)
 - ⚠ Data lives only in that folder — **don't put it in a cloud-synced folder** (conflict/leak risk).
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11. Troubleshooting (things actually hit)

Symptom	Cause	Fix
Marketplace not found	Tried to install in one step	Use the 2 steps (register → install)
Nothing gets saved	No decision sentence / session not ended	Say a clear decision sentence, then <code>/clear</code>
Screen (URL) won't open	Server not running / port conflict	<code>/o-brain:open</code> again, or change <code>OBRAIN_PORT</code> in <code>.env.local</code>
'node' is not recognized	Node.js not installed	Install LTS from nodejs.org → new window
3D graph won't show	No WebGL / low-spec	Switch to 2D
New memory/project not visible	Screen is stale	Click the refresh (↻) button (or wait — it auto-refreshes)
Projects collapsed into one	Old memories used the old rule (launch folder)	From the next <code>/clear</code> , memories auto-tag the project you actually worked in (old ones stay)
Search wrong / empty	1 character or too vague	Use 2+ characters, clearer words
Install refused (not a git repo)	Local folder	In <code>plugin</code> folder: <code>git init && git add -A &&</code>

Symptom	Cause	Fix
Moved to a new PC, doesn't work	Paths are tuned to this PC	<pre>git commit -m init</pre> Keep the same path, or ask the developer to adjust (currently single-user / this-PC)
If stuck, share the exact screen (or error message) — we'll fix it together.		

12. Safety · Privacy

- Runs **entirely on your PC**. Memories never leave over the internet.
- The screen server binds only to **127.0.0.1 (your PC)** — not reachable from other devices.
- Secrets (passwords/keys) are **auto-masked** before saving (not a perfect guarantee).
- Keeping and backing up data is **your responsibility**.

13. License · Copyright · Commercial Use (⚠️ Strict — please read)

- **Current license: Apache License 2.0 © 2026 SoDam AI Studio** (full text in the LICENSE file at the project root).
- **Personal / local use:** using it on your own PC for personal purposes is fine.
- **Redistribution / modification / commercial use:** permitted under Apache-2.0 terms (keep copyright & license notices, state changes, etc.). *That said, this repository is currently kept **private**, and whether to make it public is the author's decision.*
- **No warranty (AS-IS):** provided “as is”. **All responsibility for outcomes, data loss, or malfunction lies with the user;** the author makes no warranty whatsoever.
- **Third-party terms are separate:** if you later enable AI features (e.g., Anthropic Claude), **that provider's terms, fees, and policies apply separately** and are unrelated to O-Brain's license.

- **Trademarks / names:** “Claude”, “Anthropic”, etc. are trademarks of their owners; O-Brain is not affiliated with or endorsed by them.
 - **Bundled libraries:** O-Brain uses open-source components (e.g., better-sqlite3, sqlite-vec, force-graph, @huggingface/transformers); **each library’s own license applies.** Include their license notices when distributing.
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14. Honest Limitations (current v0.1)

- It remembers **clear decision sentences** well; vague phrasing may be missed.
 - **Topic classification is automatic but sometimes wrong** (rule-based). For relations, the *target* is **auto-suggested** (by similarity) but the *type* (supersede/support/influence/contradict) is **chosen by you** (type auto-classification can be wrong, so it’s kept human on purpose).
 - For smarter extraction, the **host LLM does it free via /o-brain:remember** — no separate API key / cost (uses the installed Claude Code/Codex).
 - It is a **single-user / this-PC** stage (moving/sharing to another PC needs extra work).
 - This is not a finished, warranted product — it’s being refined through real use.
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Written from verified, working values (v0.1, as of 2026-06-21). If something breaks, share the exact screen and we’ll fix it together.